M&A

VALUE · RISK · PMI

COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Strategic Mergers and Acquisitions - Valuation, Risk, and Integration

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2026061581

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

Version v2.0 · 13 August 2026

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome, Outcomes and Assessment

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

AM, PM and Assessment

Complete every SSG digital-attendance event shown by the trainer.

2

Scan the QR code

Use the mobile camera and submit the generated attendance form.

3

Verify submission

Tell the trainer immediately if the confirmation does not appear.

4

Funding condition

At least 75% attendance and a Competent result are required.

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template — to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

ROLE
Principal Trainer and course facilitator

SPECIALISMS
Business, technology and applied decision-making

DELIVERY
WSQ professional development and workplace application

CONTACT
enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

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INTRODUCTION

Let's Know Each Other

1

Role

Your organisation, function and decision responsibilities.

2

M&A exposure

A deal, diligence, valuation or integration experience.

3

Learning goal

The decision or capability you want to strengthen.

4

Case lens

One stakeholder whose perspective you will represent today.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1

Participate

Challenge assumptions and contribute evidence.

2

Respect

Disagree with ideas, not people.

3

Confidentiality

Use public or course data only; do not disclose live deal information.

4

Devices

Silent mode; step out quietly if needed.

5

Time

Return from breaks promptly.

6

Attendance

Maintain the required SSG attendance record.

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LESSON PLAN

Course Outline — 2 Days

Day 1

- Day 1 — Structure, Value and Forecast
  - Topic 1: deal instruments, valuation and scale
  - Activities 1–2: thesis/structure and valuation
  - Topic 2: forecast, synergies, statements and tax
  - Activities 3–4: synergy model and board challenge

Day 2

- Day 2 — Risk, Intelligence and Integration
  - Topic 3: screening, diligence, risk and BI
  - Activities 5–6: diligence and risk intelligence
  - Topic 4: governance, people and integration
  - Activities 7–8; WA 4–5pm; CS 5–6pm

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WHAT YOU WILL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

LO1

Apply financial instruments and valuation methods to structure mergers and acquisitions that optimise organisational benefit and shareholder value.

2

LO2

Evaluate the business, financial and tax impact of potential M&A deals using industry data and forecasting techniques.

3

LO3

Identify, assess and manage M&A risks across the full transaction lifecycle from target selection to post-deal integration.

4

LO4

Collaborate with stakeholders to develop and implement M&A plans while ensuring governance, synergy realisation and strategic alignment.

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TSC ALIGNMENT

Skills Framework Alignment

WST-CFI-5003-1.1-1

- Mergers and Acquisition
- One 5-level Technical Skill and Competency

Knowledge K1–K5

- Instruments · forecasts · valuation · industry · financial/tax impact

Abilities A1–A6

- Value · controls · integration · risk · intelligence · opportunity evaluation

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BEFORE ASSESSMENT

Briefing for Assessment

1

Individual

No discussion, photography or recording.

2

Open book

Use slides, Learner Guide and approved course materials only.

3

Submission

Answer in your own words and upload the completed document to the LMS.

4

Conduct

Phones and other materials under the table; follow assessor instructions.

5

Outcome

Competent or Not Yet Competent; reassessment and appeal are available.

6

Sign-off

Complete digital attendance and sign the Assessment Summary Record.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment and Funding

WA-SAQ · 1 hour

- 4 open-ended questions
- Covers K1–K5
- Open book

Case Study · 1 hour

- 3 integrated tasks
- Covers A1–A6
- Open book

Competency

- Satisfactory evidence
- At least 75% attendance
- Appeal process available

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM / SSG attendance
2. Assessment digital attendance
3. Sit WA then Case Study
4. Submit answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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HANDS-ON MATERIALS

Access the Course Activities

https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2026061581-Strategic-Mergers-and-Acquisitions-Valuation-Risk-and-Integration

Clone

git clone the repository, then open the activities folder.

Download ZIP

Use GitHub Code → Download ZIP when Git is unavailable.

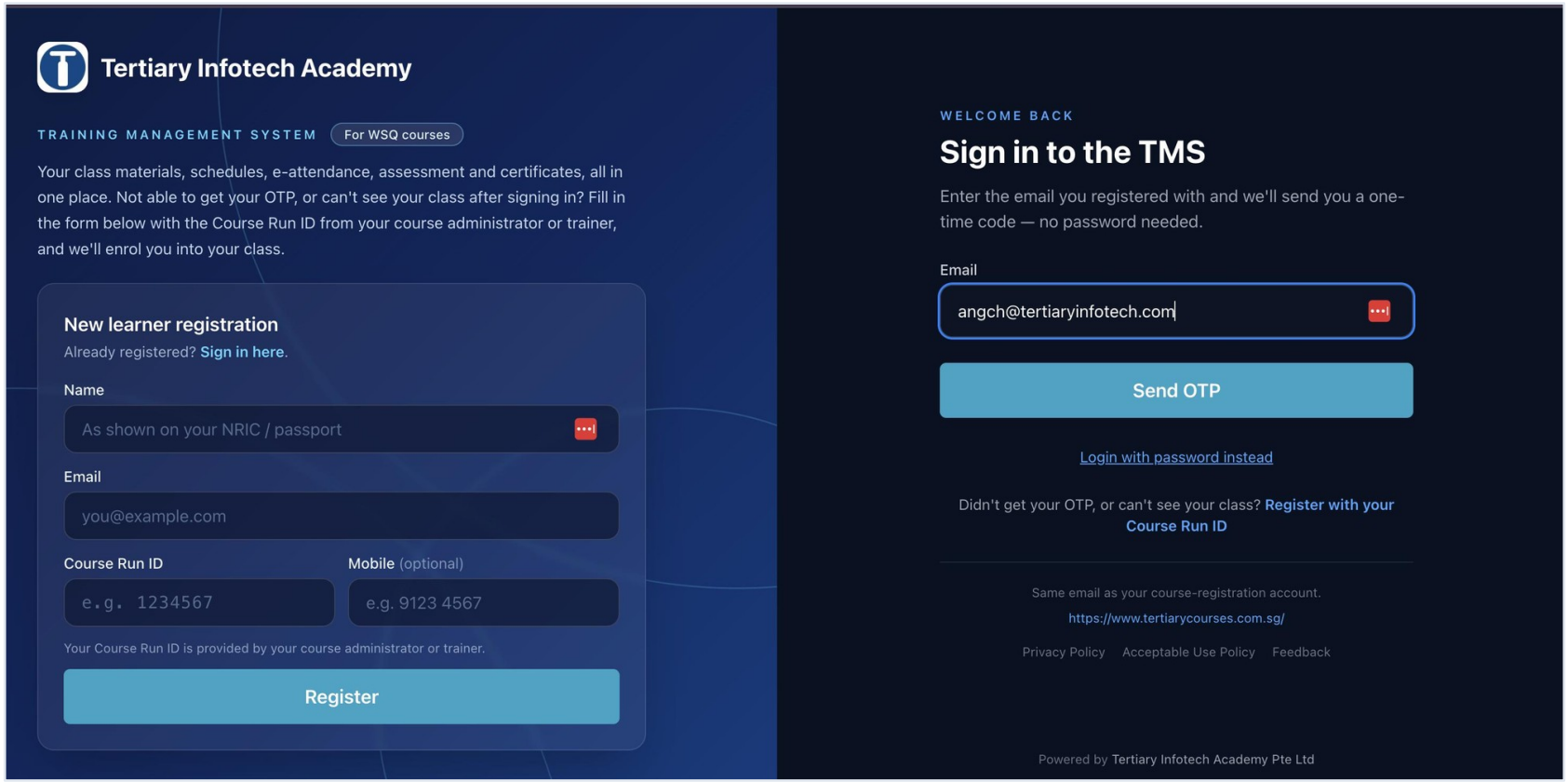
One folder each

Every activity includes scenario, questions, steps and acceptance criteria.

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COURSE PORTAL

Login to LMS and Download Course Material



Log in at lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com with your registered email and the OTP sent to your inbox, then open this course to download the slides and Learner Guide.

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COURSEWARE AND ASSESSMENT

Download Course Material

https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

1 · Sign in

Open the LMS with your registered email and password or OTP.

2 · Open course

Select this TGS course from your enrolled courses.

3 · Download

Download slides and the Learner Guide; assessments are completed on the LMS.

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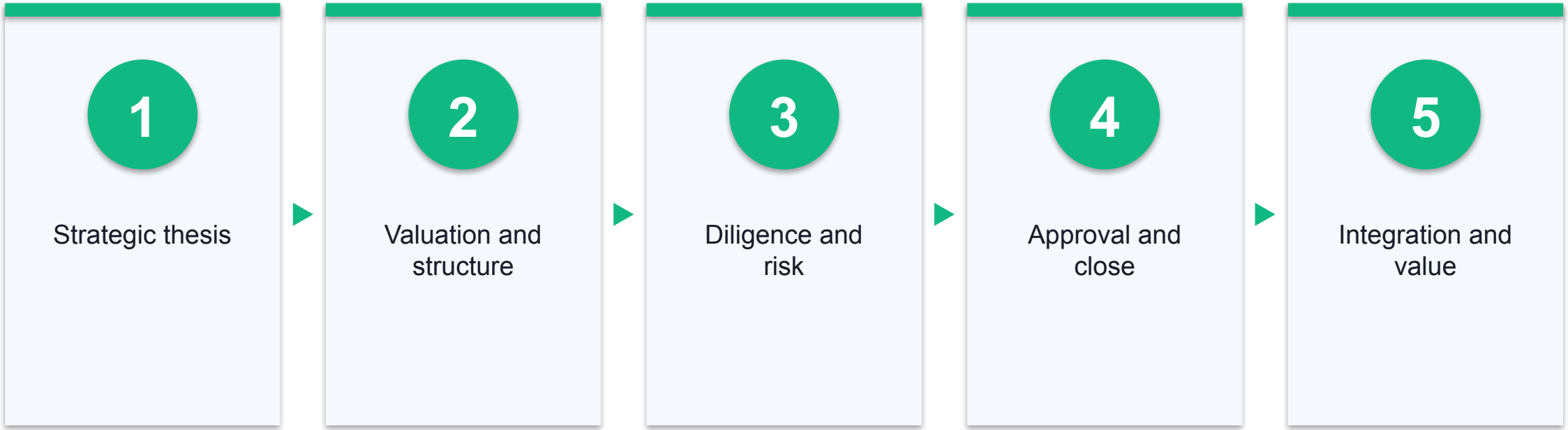
CORE MODEL

One Deal · One Evidence Chain

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END-TO-END VIEW

The decision chain



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DO NOT CONFUSE FACT WITH ASSUMPTION

Evidence hierarchy

1

Verified public fact

Published or regulatory information with source and date.

2

Management assertion

A claim to be tested against documents and operating evidence.

3

Training assumption

A simulated input used only for learning and clearly labelled.

4

Independent evidence

Third-party, customer, market, legal or specialist verification.

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COURSE CASE

A strong M&A recommendation links thesis → evidence → value → risk → owner.

If one link is missing, the decision is not ready.

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01

TOPIC 01 · K1 · K3 · A1

Deal Structuring and Valuation Principles

Financial instruments · valuation · shareholder value · economies of scale

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TSC WST-CFI-5003-1.1-1

Key Concepts — Deal Structuring and Valuation Principles

1

Deal thesis

A transaction starts with a testable strategic rationale, not a price.

2

Structure

Consideration, financing, control and risk allocation work together.

3

Value

Triangulate methods; reconcile enterprise value to equity value.

4

Discipline

Normalise earnings, challenge synergies and preserve downside protection.

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Merger, acquisition or another route?

Merger

- Businesses combine under shared control; governance must be redesigned.

Acquisition

- A buyer obtains control through shares, assets or a negotiated business transfer.

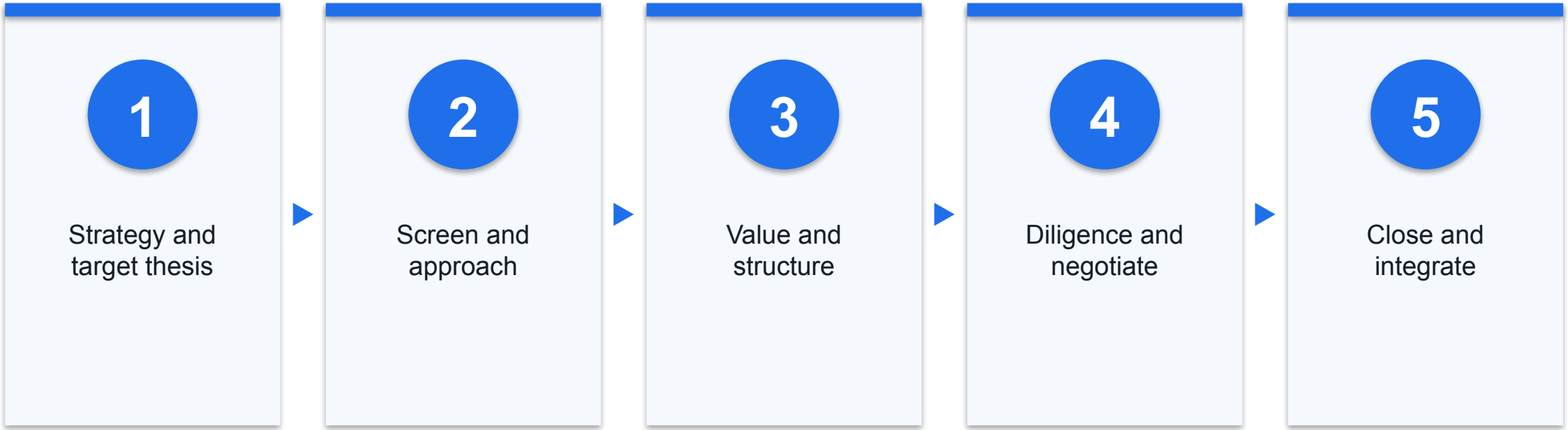
Alternatives

- Joint venture, alliance, licensing or organic build may deliver the objective with less integration risk.

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TOPIC 01 · K1 · K3 · A1

The M&A value chain



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TOPIC 01 · K1 · K3 · A1

Why organisations pursue M&A

1

Scale

Lower unit costs through procurement, systems and shared services.

2

Scope

Add capabilities, products, client segments or geographies.

3

Speed

Buy proven talent, technology, licences or distribution rather than build.

4

Resilience

Diversify revenue, reduce concentration or reinforce a strategic position.

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Consideration instruments

1

Cash

Price certainty for the seller; liquidity and leverage pressure for the buyer.

2

Shares

Shares risk and upside; introduces dilution, valuation and governance questions.

3

Earn-out

Defers value until agreed performance is achieved; definitions must be precise.

4

Rollover equity

Keeps sellers invested in NewCo and aligns them with future value creation.

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Financing and risk-allocation instruments

1

Senior debt

Lower cost and tax-deductible interest, but covenants constrain flexibility.

2

Seller note

Bridges a funding or valuation gap; seller retains credit exposure.

3

Preferred / convertible

Blends downside protection with participation in upside.

4

Escrow / holdback

Secures claims for warranties, indemnities or post-close adjustments.

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Share purchase versus asset purchase

Perspective A

- Buyer acquires the legal entity and its contracts, assets and liabilities.
- Continuity may be simpler, but unknown liabilities can follow the entity.
- Diligence, warranties and indemnities are critical.

Perspective B

- Buyer selects assets and assumed liabilities subject to transfer rules.
- May permit tax basis step-up, but consents and novation can be complex.
- Employee, licence and indirect-tax effects need local advice.

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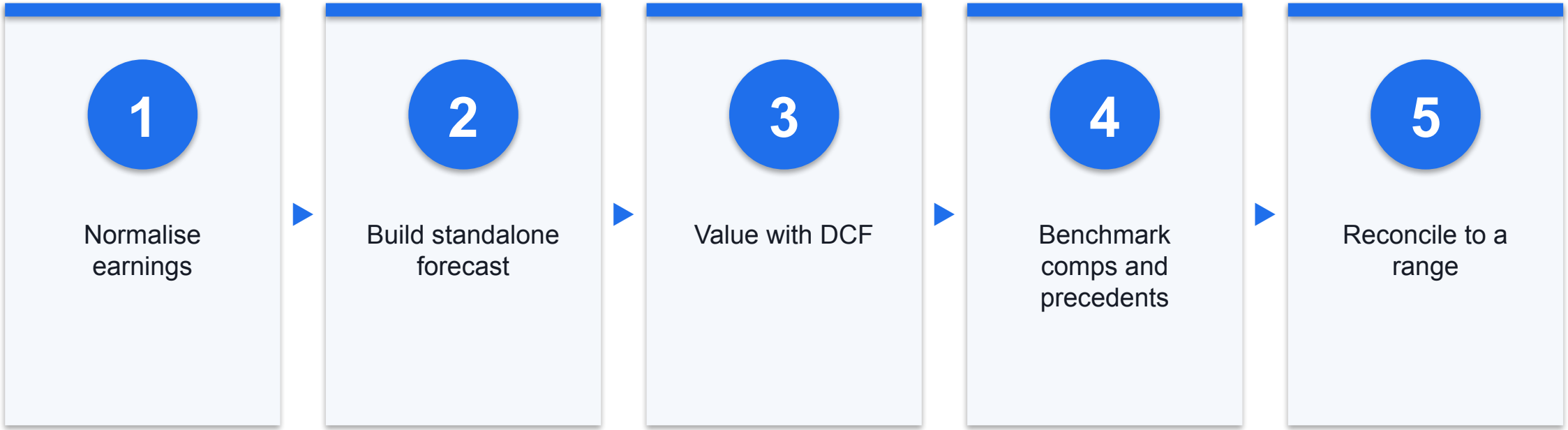
TOPIC 01 · K1 · K3 · A1

Price is what is paid; value is what the buyer can defend.

A valuation range must show assumptions, uncertainty and the bridge to the negotiated consideration.

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Valuation triangulation



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Enterprise value and equity value

1

Enterprise value

Value of operations available to debt and equity capital providers.

2

Equity bridge

EV minus debt-like items plus cash and agreed adjustments.

3

Working capital

Completion accounts or a locked-box protects the normal operating level.

4

Per-share value

Equity value divided by diluted shares, after options and other claims.

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Income approach: DCF

Perspective A

- Forecast unlevered free cash flow from operating drivers.
- Discount with a rate consistent with risk and cash-flow definition.
- Estimate terminal value without letting it dominate unexplained.

Perspective B

- DCF exposes value drivers and integration assumptions.
- It is sensitive to WACC, terminal growth, margins and reinvestment.
- Use scenarios and sensitivities; avoid false precision.

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Market approaches

Perspective A

- Trading comparables apply peer valuation multiples to the target's metric.
- They reflect current market expectations but require genuinely comparable peers.
- Adjust for scale, growth, margins, geography and business mix.

Perspective B

- Precedent transactions reflect control premiums and deal-market conditions.
- They may include strategic synergies not available to every buyer.
- Date, cycle, structure and accounting consistency matter.

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Normalising EBITDA and cash flow

1

Owner items

Replace related-party or owner compensation with market levels.

2

One-offs

Remove genuinely non-recurring items, with evidence.

3

Run-rate

Reflect contracted or implemented changes without double counting.

4

Cash conversion

Test capex, working capital and tax; EBITDA is not cash flow.

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Valuation risk controls

1

Sensitivity

Show value over a rational WACC and terminal assumption range.

2

Scenario

Build base, upside and downside operating cases.

3

Cross-check

Compare implied multiples and free-cash-flow yield.

4

Independent challenge

Separate deal advocacy from valuation review and approval.

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Value-creation levers

1

Revenue

Cross-sell, price, retention, channel and new capability.

2

Cost

Procurement, property, technology and shared services.

3

Capital

Working capital, capex, tax and portfolio optimisation.

4

Multiple

Improve recurring revenue, resilience, governance and growth quality.

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Internal economies of scale

Commercial

- Shared brand, channels, CRM and client coverage.

Operating

- Central procurement, platforms, training and administration.

Financial

- Funding access, cash pooling and professionalised controls.

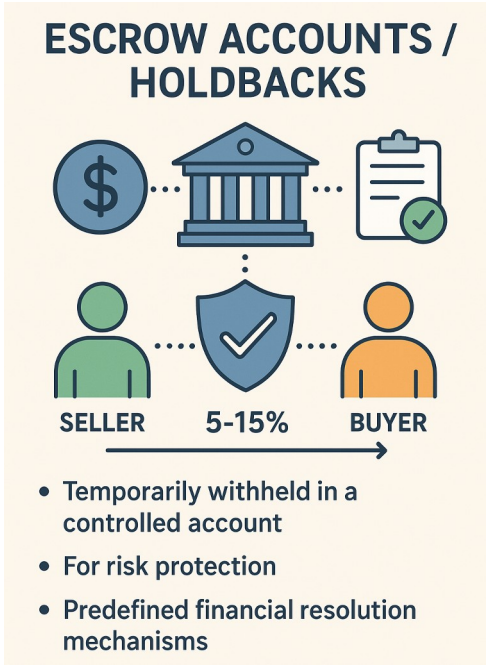
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ORIGINAL DECK · VISUAL REFERENCE

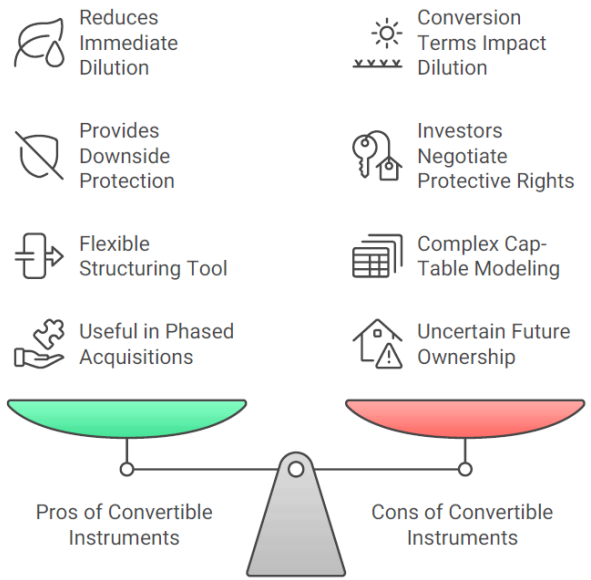
How consideration moves



Cash consideration



Escrow / holdback



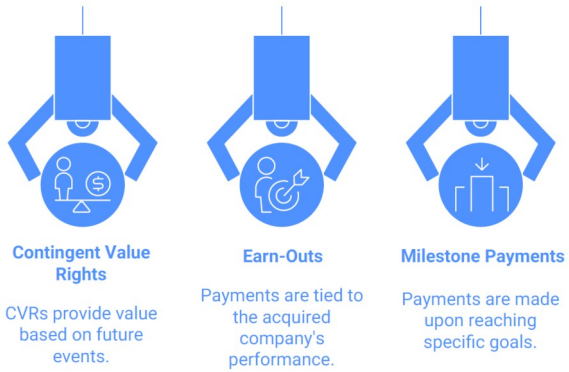
Convertible instrument

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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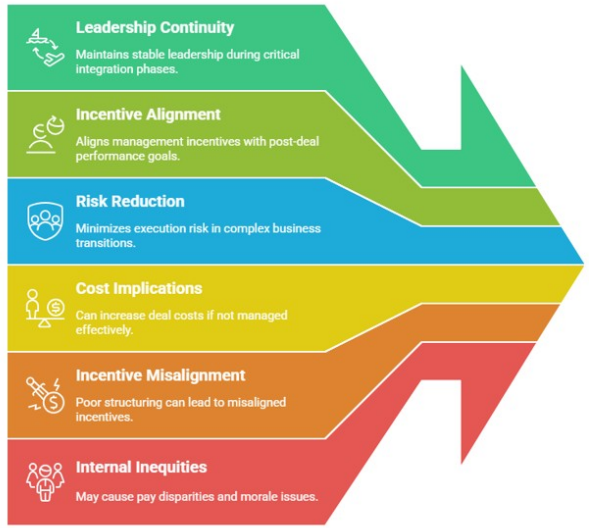
How risk is allocated



Contingent consideration



Asset purchase



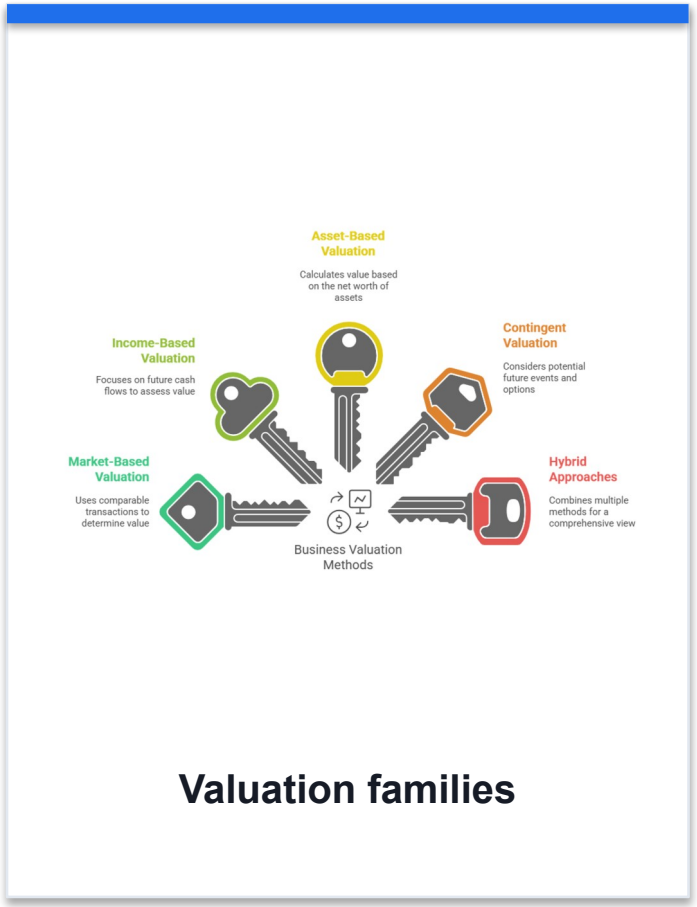
Retention mechanisms

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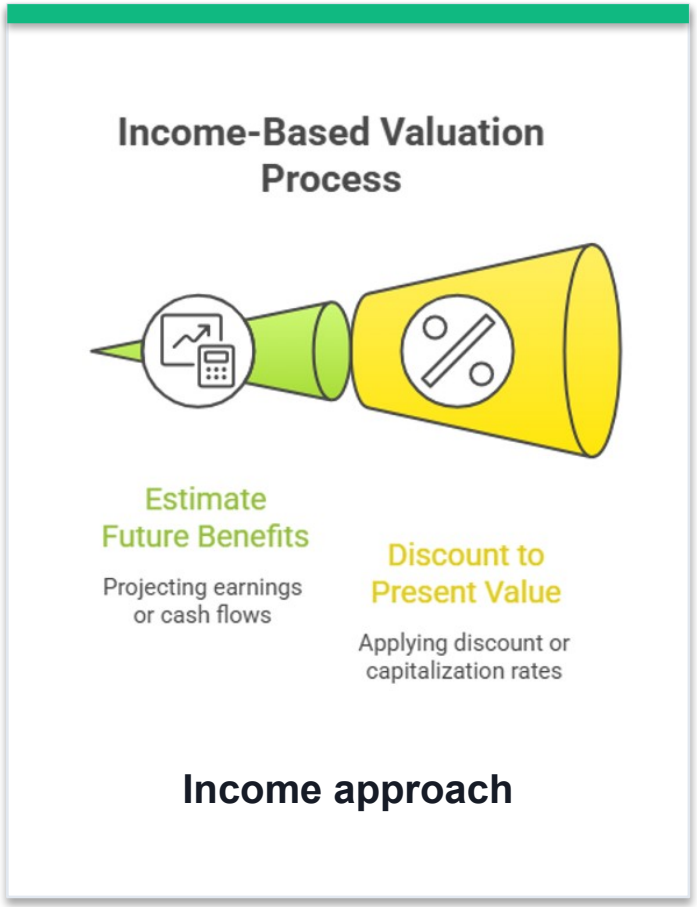
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ORIGINAL DECK · VISUAL REFERENCE

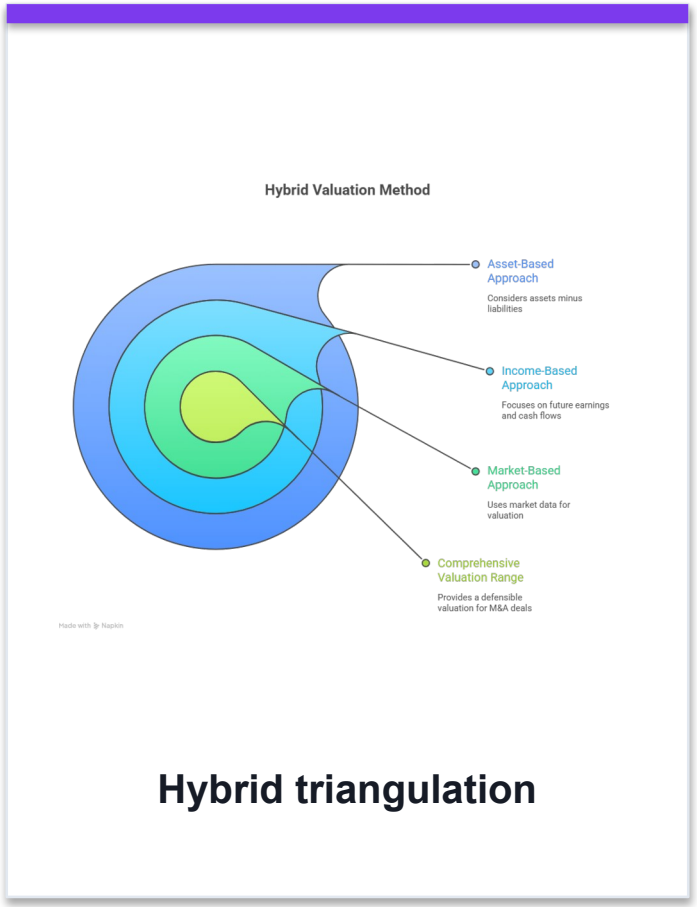
How value is triangulated



Valuation families



Income approach



Hybrid triangulation

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REAL-WORLD CASE

Applied Activities — Deal Structuring and Valuation Principles

Activity 1

- Bonadio–TGA Deal Thesis and Structure Activity
- K1 · A1 · A6

Activity 2

- Bonadio–TGA Valuation Triangulation Activity
- K3 · A1

Progressive case

- Bonadio–TGA announced transaction
- Facts separated from course assumptions

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TOPIC 01 · K1 · A1 · A6

Bonadio–TGA Deal Thesis and Structure Activity

ACTIVITY 1

Use the announced Bonadio–TGA professional-services transaction to build a defensible strategic thesis and term-sheet architecture.

You'll build

A one-page deal thesis, strategic-fit scorecard and proposed consideration/risk-allocation package

Tools / evidence: Public transaction evidence · deal-thesis canvas · structure decision matrix

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ACTIVITY 1 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

Training assumptions / limits

- No purchase price, revenue, EBITDA or ownership terms were reported; do not infer them.
- For comparison only, assume the seller values continuity, client service and continued management participation.
- Treat every proposed instrument as a learner recommendation, not an account of the actual transaction.

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ACTIVITY 1 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which facts support strategic fit, and which important facts remain unknown?
2. Would cash, rollover equity, an earn-out, a seller note or a holdback best allocate risk? Why?
3. What value could scale create without weakening TGA's specialist edge?
4. What conditions would make the team pause or walk away?

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ACTIVITY 1 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Deal Thesis and Structure Activity

✅ Test it

The page distinguishes facts from assumptions, proposes at least two instruments, links each term to a risk or value driver, and includes an explicit go/conditional/no-go recommendation.

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TOPIC 01 · K3 · A1

Bonadio–TGA Valuation Triangulation Activity

ACTIVITY 2

Build a screening valuation for the real announced transaction using clearly labelled training assumptions because the deal's financial terms were not disclosed.

You'll build

A transparent valuation workbook with DCF, trading-comparable and precedent-transaction cross-checks

Tools / evidence: Enterprise-value bridge · DCF · comparable multiples · sensitivity analysis

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ACTIVITY 2 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

Training assumptions / limits

- Training case only: FY2026 revenue US$8.0m; normalised EBITDA US$2.0m; cash tax 24%; capex US$0.20m; change in NWC US$0.10m.
- Five-year revenue growth: 8%, 7%, 6%, 5%, 4%; EBITDA margin gradually rises from 25% to 27%.
- DCF base: WACC 12%; terminal growth 3%; net debt US$0.50m.

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ACTIVITY 2 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. What adjustments are needed to move reported EBITDA to normalised EBITDA?
2. What value range emerges from DCF and the 7.0x–9.0x multiple cross-check?
3. How does enterprise value bridge to equity value?
4. Which two assumptions drive the widest value change?

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ACTIVITY 2 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Valuation Triangulation Activity

✅ Test it

The model is formula-driven, shows sources/assumptions, has a working sensitivity table and reconciles DCF with the multiple range without claiming undisclosed deal facts.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Deal Structuring and Valuation Principles

1

Bonadio–TGA Deal Thesis and Structure Activity

Apply financial instruments to shape a deal structure (K1, A1, A6)

2

Bonadio–TGA Valuation Triangulation Activity

Apply business valuation concepts and reconcile a valuation range (K3, A1)

3

Decision habit

Separate facts, assumptions and unresolved evidence.

4

Transfer

Carry valuation and diligence commitments into integration ownership.

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Lunch Break

60 minutes

02

TOPIC 02 · K2 · K5 · A1 · A2

Forecasting, Financial and Tax Implications

Business impact · synergies · pro forma statements · tax

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Key Concepts — Forecasting, Financial and Tax Implications

1

Standalone first

Forecast the target before adding buyer-specific synergies.

2

Timing matters

Separate run-rate benefit, ramp-up and one-off cost to achieve.

3

Three statements

Trace assumptions through profit, cash flow and the balance sheet.

4

Tax is contextual

Structure effects require jurisdiction-specific professional advice.

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Build a defensible deal forecast

1. Historical quality
2. Standalone drivers
3. Synergy cases
4. Integration costs
5. Cash and returns

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TOPIC 02 · K2 · K5 · A1 · A2

Standalone forecast drivers

1. **Volume**
   Clients, units, capacity, utilisation or transactions.

2. **Price and mix**
   Rate cards, discounts, segment mix and churn.

3. **Margin**
   Labour productivity, procurement, delivery model and overhead.

4. **Investment**
   Capex, working capital, technology and compliance.

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Synergy taxonomy

1

Revenue

Cross-sell, pricing, retention and new routes to market.

2

Cost

Duplicate roles, vendors, facilities and systems.

3

Capital

Working capital, capex avoidance and financing efficiency.

4

Dis-synergy

Client loss, talent exits, service disruption or cannibalisation.

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Run-rate benefit versus cash realisation

Perspective A

- Run-rate is the annualised benefit once fully implemented.
- A phased ramp recognises hiring cycles, contracts and operational dependencies.
- Owners and dates turn ambition into an integration commitment.

Perspective B

- Cash realisation nets cost-to-achieve, tax and working-capital effects.
- Track both recurring benefit and one-off spend.
- Avoid recognising a synergy before the underlying action is complete.

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Integration costs

1

People

Retention, severance, relocation and training.

2

Technology

Migration, licences, cybersecurity and data remediation.

3

Operations

Rebranding, facilities, process redesign and advisers.

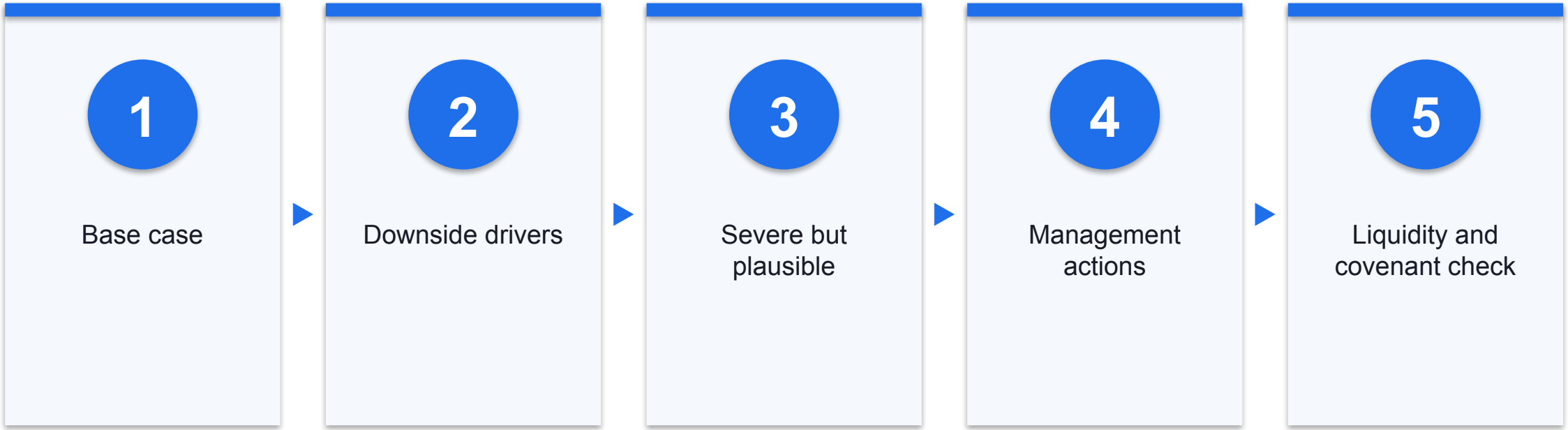
4

Contingency

A transparent risk allowance linked to specific uncertainty.

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Scenario design



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Deal return measures

1

NPV

Present value of incremental cash flows less investment.

2

IRR

Discount rate at which deal cash flows have zero NPV.

3

ROIC

Post-tax operating profit relative to invested capital.

4

Payback

Time until cumulative cash inflow recovers the investment.

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Accretion/dilution is not intrinsic value

Perspective A

- EPS accretion asks whether pro forma EPS rises after financing and accounting effects.
- It can be influenced by relative P/E multiples, funding mix and buyback alternatives.
- A deal can be EPS-accretive yet destroy economic value.

Perspective B

- Value creation asks whether return exceeds the risk-adjusted cost of capital.
- Use NPV/ROIC, strategic option value and downside resilience.
- Report both views to decision-makers.

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Financial statement effects

1

Profit and loss

New revenue/cost base, financing, amortisation and integration charges.

2

Balance sheet

Consideration, debt, goodwill, intangibles and deferred tax.

3

Cash flow

Purchase consideration, transaction costs, integration spend and working capital.

4

Ratios

Leverage, liquidity, interest cover, margins and covenant headroom.

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Purchase price allocation

1. Identify consideration
2. Fair-value assets/liabilities
3. Recognise intangibles
4. Record deferred tax
5. Residual goodwill

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Tax diligence questions

1

Compliance

Returns, audits, uncertain positions and indirect taxes.

2

Attributes

Losses, credits and incentives, including limits after ownership change.

3

Structure

Share/asset route, financing, withholding and stamp duties.

4

Integration

Transfer pricing, systems, tax governance and reporting readiness.

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Effective tax rate: opportunity and guardrail

Perspective A

- Interest may create a tax shield subject to deductibility limits.
- Tax attributes can have value only if legally usable and supported by future profits.
- Asset basis and intangible deductions vary by jurisdiction.

Perspective B

- Do not optimise the model without legal substance and business purpose.
- Model cash tax separately from accounting tax expense.
- Escalate cross-border, anti-avoidance and transfer-pricing questions to advisers.

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TOPIC 02 · K2 · K5 · A1 · A2

Checks and balances before approval

1

Data owner

Every key assumption has a named source and as-of date.

2

Independent case

Finance challenges sponsor assumptions and double counting.

3

Risk gate

Legal, tax, compliance, cyber and people leads sign off.

4

Board view

Decision paper shows range, downside, mitigations and walk-away conditions.

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TOPIC 02 · K2 · K5 · A1 · A2

A synergy is not value until an action, owner, date and cash impact are traceable.

Forecasting connects the investment case to integration execution.

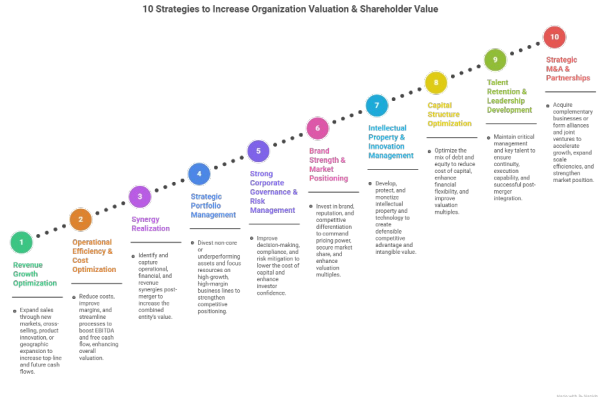
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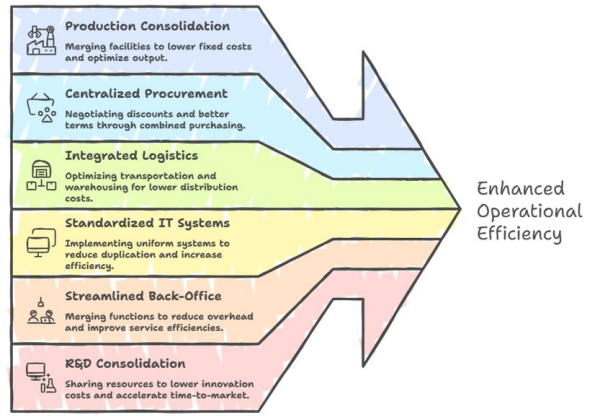
How value grows



Value levers



Value roadmap



Scale pathways

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

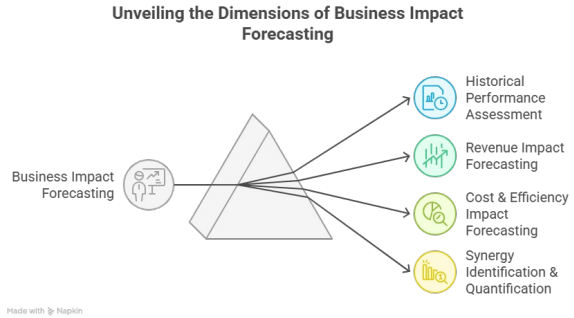
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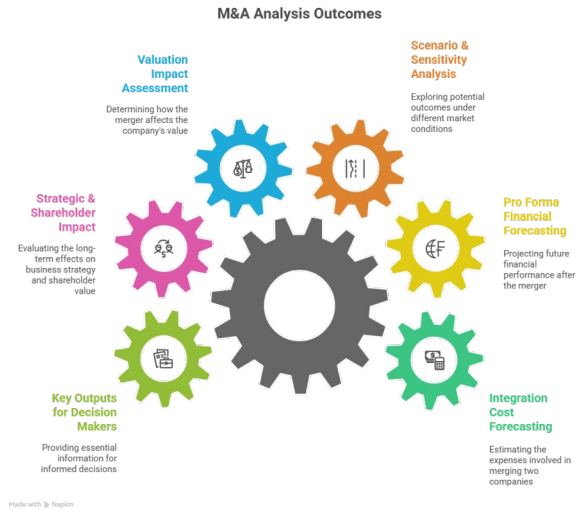
How forecasts connect



Business-impact forecast



Forecast dimensions



Integrated analysis

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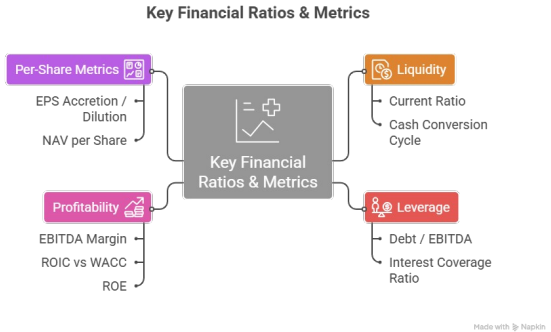
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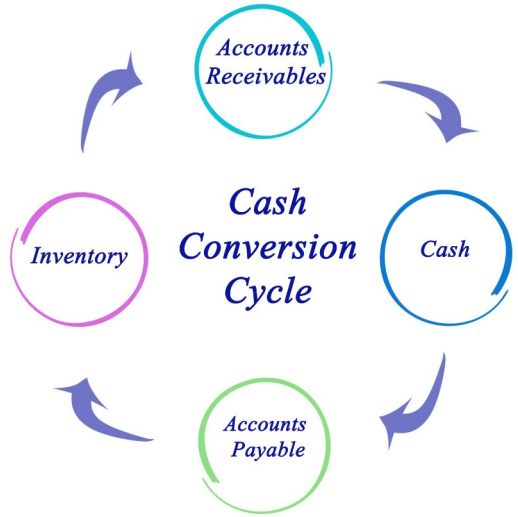
How finance is challenged



Tax considerations



Financial ratios



Cash conversion cycle

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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REAL-WORLD CASE

Applied Activities — Forecasting, Financial and Tax Implications

Activity 3

- Bonadio–TGA Three-Year Synergy Forecast Activity
- K2 · A1 · A2 · A5

Activity 4

- Bonadio–TGA Pro Forma and Tax Challenge Activity
- K5 · A1 · A2

Progressive case

- Bonadio–TGA announced transaction
- Facts separated from course assumptions

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TOPIC 02 · K2 · A1 · A2 · A5

Bonadio–TGA Three-Year Synergy Forecast Activity

ACTIVITY 3

Translate the public strategic rationale into a three-year base/downside/upside forecast with a traceable synergy bridge.

You'll build

A standalone-to-combined forecast, synergy register, cost-to-achieve schedule and executive dashboard

Tools / evidence: Driver model · synergy bridge · scenarios · NPV/ROIC · BI dashboard

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ACTIVITY 3 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

Training assumptions / limits

- Use Activity 2's course-only financial base; none of the financial inputs are reported transaction facts.
- Potential value levers may include cross-selling credit-risk, loan-review and regulatory-advisory services across Bonadio's financial-institution clients.
- Model base synergies: revenue US$0.25m/0.60m/1.00m; cost US$0.10m/0.25m/0.35m in Years 1–3.

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ACTIVITY 3 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which synergy levers are buyer-specific and incremental to standalone performance?
2. What is the Year 3 run-rate synergy and cumulative cash realisation?
3. How do downside assumptions affect NPV, ROIC and payback?
4. Which leading indicators should the IMO monitor before financial benefits appear?

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ACTIVITY 3 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Three-Year Synergy Forecast Activity

✅ Test it

Standalone and synergy cases are separate; every synergy has an owner and timing; cash impact includes cost-to-achieve and tax; downside results are visible.

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TOPIC 02 · K5 · A1 · A2

Bonadio–TGA Pro Forma and Tax Challenge Activity

ACTIVITY 4

Trace an illustrative acquisition through the income statement, balance sheet and cash flow, then challenge tax and control assumptions.

You'll build

A pro forma bridge, purchase-price allocation sketch, tax issue list and board challenge paper

Tools / evidence: Pro forma statements · PPA · goodwill · leverage · tax diligence · approval gate

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ACTIVITY 4 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

Training assumptions / limits

- Training case only: purchase enterprise value US$16.0m; consideration 60% cash/debt and 40% buyer equity.
- Illustrative identifiable intangible assets: client relationships US$4.0m and trade name US$1.0m; assumed useful lives 8 and 5 years.
- Illustrative fair-value adjustment to other net assets: US$1.5m; deferred-tax rate 24%.

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ACTIVITY 4 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. What drives goodwill under the training PPA?
2. How do financing, intangible amortisation and integration charges affect earnings and cash differently?
3. Which tax attributes or exposures need documentary evidence?
4. What approval conditions should the independent review team impose?

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ACTIVITY 4 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Pro Forma and Tax Challenge Activity

✅ Test it

The pack ties across sources/uses and statement bridges, labels training assumptions, distinguishes cash/non-cash and recurring/one-off items, and lists unresolved tax evidence.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Forecasting, Financial and Tax Implications

1

Bonadio–TGA Three-Year Synergy Forecast Activity

Forecast business impact and assess effects on financial performance (K2, A1, A2, A5)

2

Bonadio–TGA Pro Forma and Tax Challenge Activity

Evaluate financial and tax implications and act as checks and balances (K5, A1, A2)

3

Decision habit

Separate facts, assumptions and unresolved evidence.

4

Transfer

Carry valuation and diligence commitments into integration ownership.

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End of Day 1

Return tomorrow ready to challenge the deal

03

TOPIC 03 · K4 · A4 · A5 · A6

Target Identification, Risk and Intelligence

Industry intelligence · screening · diligence · risk · BI

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TSC WST-CFI-5003-1.1-1

Key Concepts — Target Identification, Risk and Intelligence

1

Thesis-led search

Define the capability gap and target archetype before scanning names.

2

Evidence hierarchy

Triangulate management data with external, operational and customer evidence.

3

Holistic risk

Financial, operational, strategic, regulatory, cultural and external risks interact.

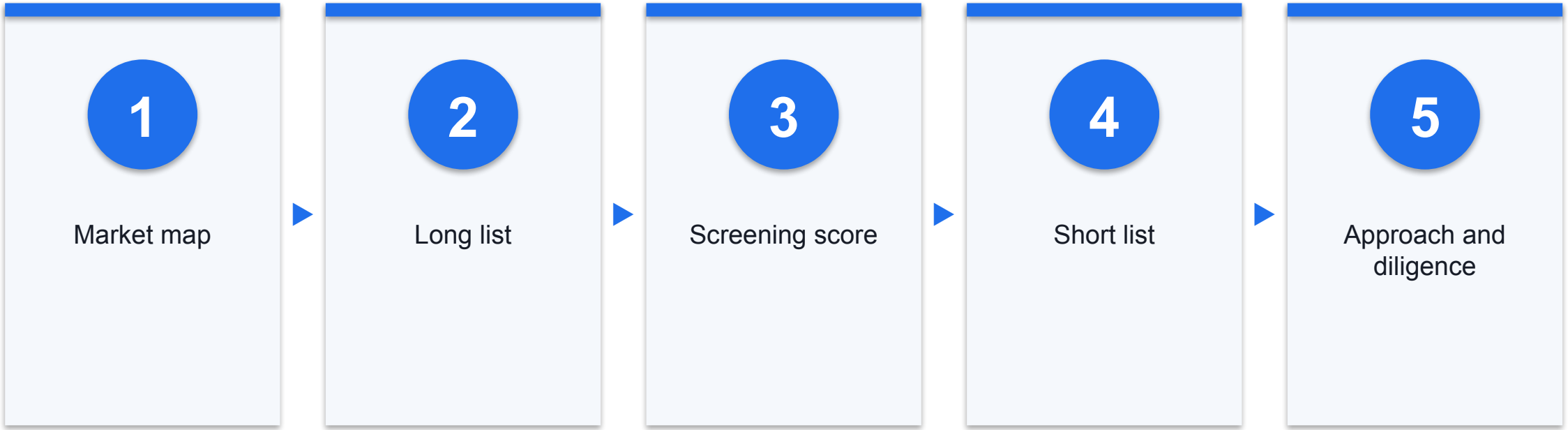
4

Decision intelligence

Dashboards support judgement; they do not replace accountable approval.

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Target-screening funnel



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TOPIC 03 · K4 · A4 · A5 · A6

Industry intelligence

1

Market

Growth, concentration, customer demand and disruption.

2

Competition

Differentiation, entry barriers, pricing pressure and substitutes.

3

Capability

Talent, patents, licences, data, technology and delivery model.

4

Context

Tax, regulation, geopolitics, ESG and funding conditions.

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Screening criteria

1

Strategic fit

Does the target directly advance the deal thesis?

2

Financial quality

Growth, margin, cash conversion and recurring revenue.

3

Synergy fit

Specific buyer advantages without double counting.

4

Executability

Valuation, owner intent, approvals and integration capacity.

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Patents and intellectual property

Perspective A

- Confirm ownership, registrations, licences and freedom to operate.
- Identify open-source, contractor and employee-created IP exposure.
- Assess remaining life, enforceability and revenue dependence.

Perspective B

- Map IP to products, customers and the deal thesis.
- Evaluate obsolescence and substitute technologies.
- Reflect remediation, protection cost and uncertainty in price or terms.

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Due diligence workstreams

1. Commercial and strategic
2. Financial and tax
3. Legal and regulatory
4. Operations and technology
5. People, culture and ESG

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Quality of earnings

1

Revenue

Recognition, cut-off, concentration, backlog and churn.

2

Costs

Run-rate staffing, related parties, capitalisation and one-offs.

3

Working capital

Seasonality, ageing, provisions and normal level.

4

Cash

Conversion, capex, debt-like items and off-balance-sheet obligations.

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MDPI review: four connected risk themes

1

Information asymmetry

Unequal or opaque information can distort price and decisions.

2

Performance and reputation

Operating outcomes and stakeholder trust influence each other.

3

Litigation and investor protection

Rights, enforcement and governance affect downside.

4

Geopolitical factors

Policy, sanctions and uncertainty can change feasibility and value.

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Enterprise M&A risk classes

1

Financial

Overpayment, leverage, liquidity and forecast error.

2

Operational

Process, systems, service continuity and supply chain.

3

Strategic

Weak rationale, competition, customer response and disruption.

4

Regulatory and cultural

Approvals, compliance, leadership, talent and behaviour.

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Risk identification and prioritisation

Perspective A

- Fishbone analysis prompts causes across people, process, technology, data, market and governance.
- Diligence findings should describe cause, event and consequence.
- Link every material risk to valuation or integration.

Perspective B

- Score likelihood and impact with defined scales.
- Use weighted multi-criteria methods only when assumptions are transparent.
- Prioritise by exposure, velocity, detectability and control strength.

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Risk response

1. Avoid
2. Reduce
3. Transfer or allocate
4. Accept with appetite
5. Monitor and escalate

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Diligence red flags

1

Earnings

Late adjustments, unexplained margins or unsupported add-backs.

2

Concentration

Dependence on a client, partner, employee, licence or platform.

3

Control

Weak approvals, data lineage, cybersecurity or regulatory evidence.

4

Culture

Leadership gaps, regretted attrition, grievance patterns or conflicting incentives.

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TOPIC 03 · K4 · A4 · A5 · A6

Business intelligence for deal analysis

1

Market view

Peer multiples, pricing, market share and customer sentiment.

2

Target view

Cohorts, margin bridges, pipeline, churn and productivity.

3

Risk view

Exceptions, incidents, litigation, cyber and compliance indicators.

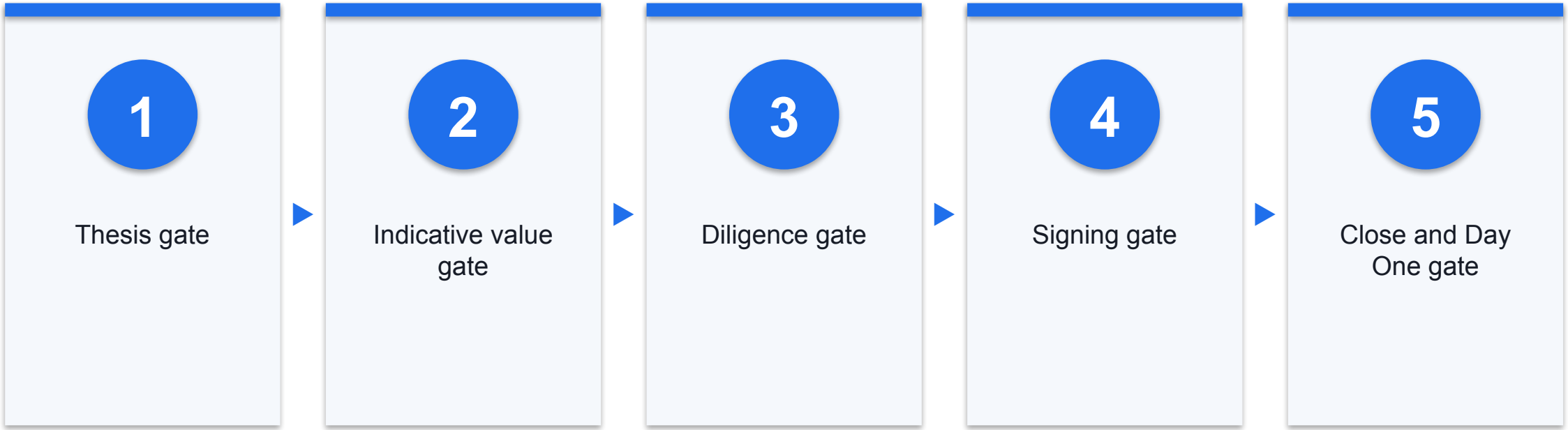
4

Integration view

Synergy, milestones, talent, clients and Day One readiness.

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Decision gates



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TOPIC 03 · K4 · A4 · A5 · A6

Uncertainty should change price, terms, protection or the decision—not disappear in a footnote.

A strong deal team makes uncertainty visible early enough to act.

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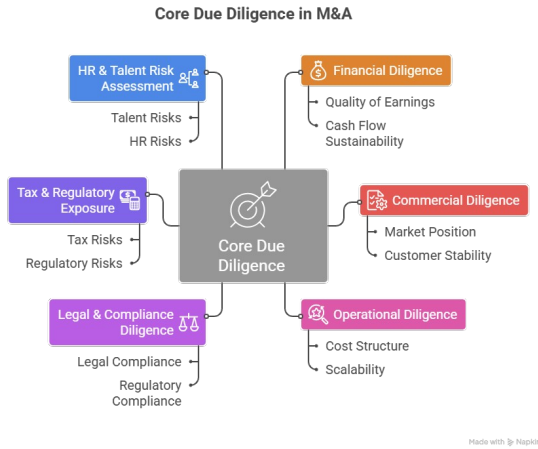
How targets are screened



Target screening



Due diligence



Diligence workstreams

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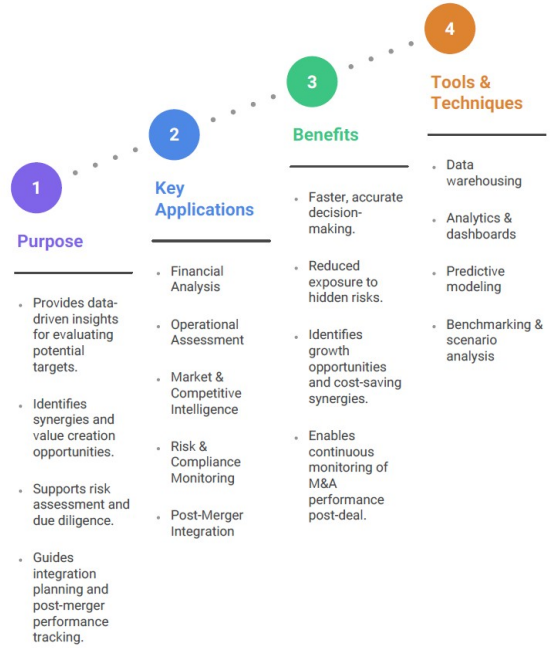
How risk becomes evidence



Risk map



Business intelligence



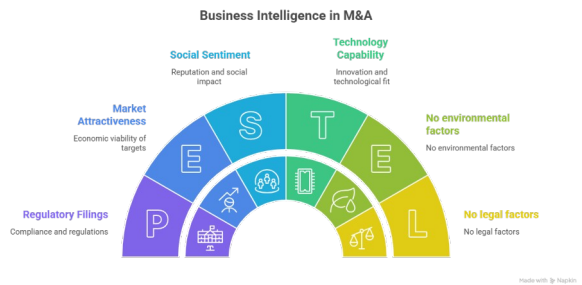
Intelligence flow

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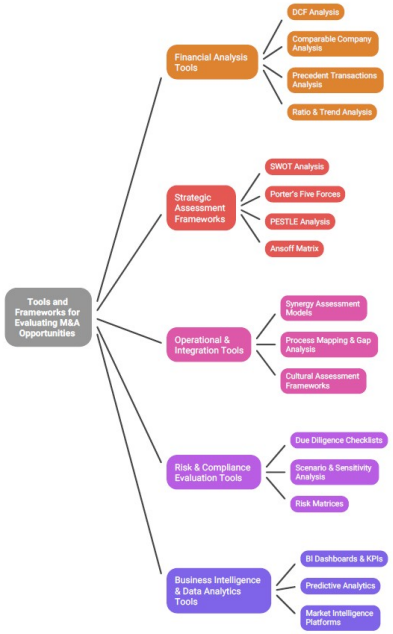
How the decision is framed



PESTLE lens



Evaluation toolkit



Evaluation tree

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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REAL-WORLD CASE

Applied Activities — Target Identification, Risk and Intelligence

Activity 5

- Bonadio–TGA Target Screening and Diligence Activity
- K4 · A4 · A6

Activity 6

- Bonadio–TGA M&A Risk Intelligence Activity
- A2 · A4 · A5 · A6

Progressive case

- Bonadio–TGA announced transaction
- Facts separated from course assumptions

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TOPIC 03 · K4 · A4 · A6

Bonadio–TGA Target Screening and Diligence Activity

ACTIVITY 5

Convert the public transaction rationale into a target-screening scorecard and a diligence plan that tests specialist capability, client trust and regulatory quality.

You'll build

A target-screening scorecard, evidence request list and diligence workplan

Tools / evidence: Market map · screening criteria · evidence hierarchy · QoE · commercial/legal/tech/people diligence

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ACTIVITY 5 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

Training assumptions / limits

- Verified facts include TGA's reported service areas, founding year, target client type and planned Bonadio business-unit placement.
- Client concentration, financial performance, staff roster, contracts, cyber posture and regulatory findings are unknown and must be requested.
- The exercise tests whether the announced rationale is supported; it does not assert undisclosed findings.

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ACTIVITY 5 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which screening criteria best test the announced capability-expansion thesis?
2. What evidence would confirm service quality and sticky client relationships?
3. Which diligence items can change value, structure or the decision?
4. What must be handed from diligence to the integration team?

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ACTIVITY 5 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Target Screening and Diligence Activity

✅ Test it

Weights total 100%, scores cite evidence status, every high-risk item has an owner and decision impact, and diligence findings flow into integration actions.

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TOPIC 03 · A2 · A4 · A5 · A6

Bonadio–TGA M&A Risk Intelligence Activity

ACTIVITY 6

Apply the MDPI risk themes and the SSRN enterprise-risk framework to the real announced deal, then create a decision dashboard and escalation memo.

You'll build

A risk taxonomy, heat map, bow-tie controls, BI dashboard and go/conditional/no-go memo

Tools / evidence: MDPI risk themes · Fishbone · risk scoring · controls · leading indicators · decision gates

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ACTIVITY 6 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.mdpi.com/2227-9091/12/9/143

Training assumptions / limits

- The MDPI review identifies four connected themes: information asymmetry; performance/reputation; litigation/investor protection; geopolitical factors.
- The SSRN review discusses financial, operational, strategic, regulatory and cultural risk and structured identification/quantification methods.
- Risks used in this case are hypotheses for diligence, not allegations about either firm.

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ACTIVITY 6 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. How do information asymmetry and reputation risk interact in a regulated advisory business?
2. Which causes sit behind client loss, specialist-talent loss and regulatory-quality failure?
3. What controls reduce likelihood and what recovery actions reduce impact?
4. Which metrics and thresholds should trigger escalation?

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ACTIVITY 6 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA M&A Risk Intelligence Activity

✅ Test it

Risk statements are specific, scoring scales are defined, controls have owners, dashboard thresholds are actionable and the recommendation follows the evidence.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Target Identification, Risk and Intelligence

1

Bonadio–TGA Target Screening and Diligence Activity

Use industry intelligence to screen a target and plan risk-based diligence (K4, A4, A6)

2

Bonadio–TGA M&A Risk Intelligence Activity

Use BI to assess and manage M&A risk across the lifecycle (A2, A4, A5, A6)

3

Decision habit

Separate facts, assumptions and unresolved evidence.

4

Transfer

Carry valuation and diligence commitments into integration ownership.

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Lunch Break

60 minutes

04

TOPIC 04 · A2 · A3 · K2

Stakeholder Alignment and Post-Merger Integration

Governance · checks and balances · IMO · culture · change

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TSC WST-CFI-5003-1.1-1

Key Concepts — Stakeholder Alignment and Post-Merger Integration

1

Integration starts before close

Diligence findings and the deal thesis must transfer into the plan.

2

Governance enables pace

Decision rights, escalation and cadence prevent cross-functional drift.

3

Protect value

Client continuity, talent and culture are economic value drivers.

4

Measure outcomes

Track commitments, not activity volume.

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Stakeholder map

1

Governance

Board, SteerCo, deal executive and regulators.

2

Delivery

IMO, workstream leads, integration teams and business owners.

3

People

Leaders, employees, talent groups and representatives.

4

External

Clients, suppliers, lenders, partners and communities.

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RACI and decision rights

Perspective A

- Responsible performs the work; Accountable owns the outcome.
- Consulted contributes before a decision; Informed receives the result.
- One accountable owner avoids committee ambiguity.

Perspective B

- Define reserved decisions, thresholds and escalation routes.
- Separate deal sponsorship from independent control challenge.
- Record decisions, assumptions, owners and due dates.

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EY: nine integration steps

1. **Step 1** — Value drivers and principles
2. **Step 2** — Legal interaction rules
3. **Step 3** — Stand up IMO
4. **Step 4** — Day One charters
5. **Step 5** — Operating model
6. **Step 6** — Functional plans
7. **Step 7** — Execute
8. **Step 8** — Capture value
9. **Step 9** — Manage stakeholders

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Three-tier integration governance

SteerCo

- Sets direction and resolves the highest-significance issues.

IMO

- Coordinates workstreams, risks, dependencies, decisions and value.

Functional teams

- Deliver milestones and resolve day-to-day issues.

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Pre-close guardrails

1

Clean team

Restrict competitively sensitive data to authorised reviewers.

2

Gun-jumping

Do not control the target before legal close.

3

Confidentiality

Define channels, access, retention and permitted use.

4

Readiness

Plan Day One without prematurely implementing control.

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Day One must-haves

1

People

Leadership, employment continuity, access and emergency contacts.

2

Clients

Service continuity, relationship owners and approved messages.

3

Controls

Authority limits, cash, compliance, cyber and incident escalation.

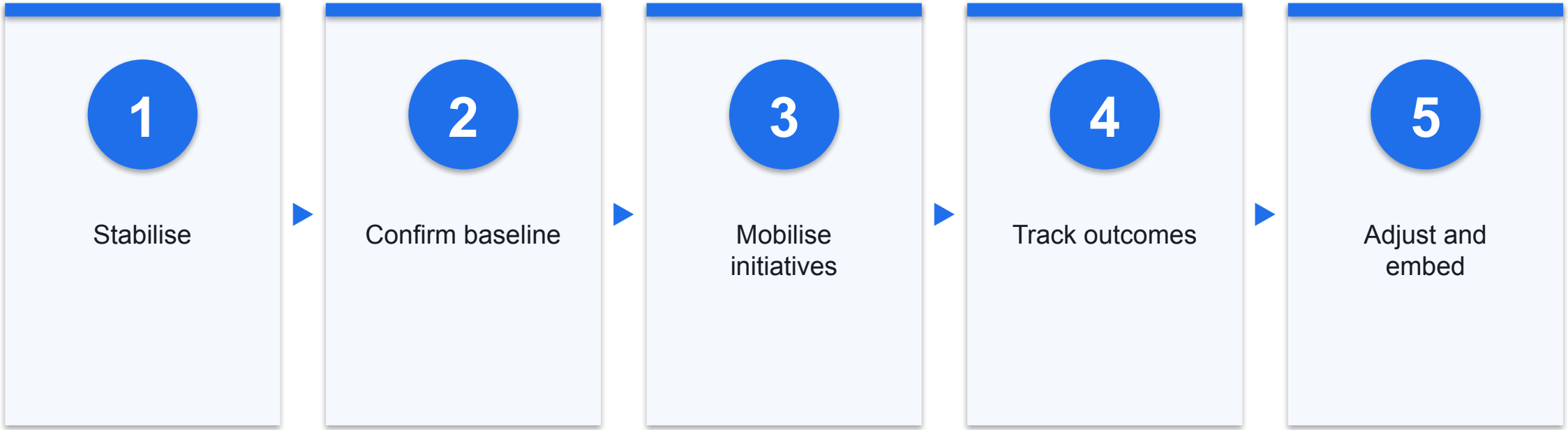
4

Operations

Systems access, critical vendors, sites and business continuity.

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First 100 days



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Integration strategy choices

1

Absorption

Fully integrate when standardisation and scale are central to value.

2

Preservation

Protect autonomy when brand, culture or specialist capability drives value.

3

Symbiosis

Share selected capabilities while allowing mutual adaptation.

4

Holding

Maintain a portfolio relationship with limited operational integration.

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Synergy governance

1

Baseline

Freeze the standalone reference point and avoid moving targets.

2

Initiative

Name the action, owner, milestone, dependency and cost-to-achieve.

3

Finance validation

Confirm recurring P&L and cash impact; remove double counting.

4

Reporting

Separate forecast, achieved, at-risk and lost value.

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Culture integration

Perspective A

- Profile decision style, client model, risk appetite, incentives and leadership behaviours.
- Identify where differences are complementary and where they threaten the thesis.
- Design the future culture through observable behaviours, not slogans.

Perspective B

- Listen through interviews, surveys, data and leader observation.
- Protect critical identity where specialist trust creates value.
- Track regretted attrition, engagement, client continuity and conduct indicators.

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Professional services integration

1. **Talent**
   Retention combines economics, career opportunity, identity and clarity.

2. **Clients**
   Relationship continuity and conflict checks protect revenue.

3. **Governance**
   Partner autonomy must align with board, risk and reporting discipline.

4. **Technology**
   Data, workflow and platforms should scale without weakening quality.

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Change and communication plan

1

Audience

Map what each stakeholder needs to know, feel and do.

2

Message

Explain the rationale, impact, timing and unresolved questions honestly.

3

Channel

Use leader cascades, client outreach, town halls and two-way forums.

4

Feedback

Track sentiment, rumours, adoption barriers and response actions.

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Integration scorecard

1

Value

Revenue, cost, capital and cost-to-achieve.

2

Customers

Retention, pipeline, complaints and service levels.

3

People

Critical talent retention, engagement and role fill.

4

Execution and risk

Milestones, dependencies, incidents and controls.

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TOPIC 04 · A2 · A3 · K2

Closing completes the transaction; integration must still earn the value.

The deal thesis becomes an operating commitment on Day One.

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ORIGINAL DECK · VISUAL REFERENCE

How stakeholders govern



Stakeholder engagement



Checks and balances



Culture and change

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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ORIGINAL DECK · VISUAL REFERENCE

How integration is mobilised



Post-merger integration



Implementation plan



Culture and change

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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ORIGINAL DECK · VISUAL REFERENCE

How the original story connects



Valuation strategy



Scale strategy



Transaction examples

Reused from the supplied original PPT; interpret using the updated v2.0 concepts and evidence.

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REAL-WORLD CASE

Applied Activities — Stakeholder Alignment and Post-Merger Integration

Activity 7

- Bonadio–TGA Integration Program Design Activity
- A2 · A3 · A4

Activity 8

- Bonadio–TGA Culture, Talent and Client Continuity Activity
- K2 · A2 · A3

Progressive case

- Bonadio–TGA announced transaction
- Facts separated from course assumptions

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TOPIC 04 · A2 · A3 · A4

Bonadio–TGA Integration Program Design Activity

ACTIVITY 7

Use EY's nine-step integration framework to turn the Bonadio–TGA deal thesis and diligence findings into a Day One and first-100-days program.

You'll build

Integration strategy, governance/RACI, workstream charters, Day One checklist and 100-day roadmap

Tools / evidence: SteerCo · IMO · workstreams · legal guardrails · operating model · synergy governance

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ACTIVITY 7 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.ey.com/content/dam/ey-unified-site/ey-com/en-gl/insights/mergers-acquisitions/documents/ey-nine-key-steps-to-setting-up-merger-acquisition-integration-program.pdf

Training assumptions / limits

- The exercise occurs before the expected close, so integration planning must respect confidentiality and gun-jumping restrictions.
- TGA is expected to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit; detailed operating-model decisions are not publicly reported.
- Learner choices are recommendations based on the deal thesis and risk analysis.

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ACTIVITY 7 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which value drivers and guiding principles should govern integration decisions?
2. What belongs with SteerCo, IMO and functional workstreams?
3. What must be ready on Day One, and what should be phased?
4. How will the team prove that value is captured without weakening quality?

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ACTIVITY 7 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Integration Program Design Activity

✅ Test it

The blueprint maps all nine EY steps, separates pre-close planning from post-close control, assigns governance and owners, and links integration actions to value and risk.

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TOPIC 04 · K2 · A2 · A3

Bonadio–TGA Culture, Talent and Client Continuity Activity

ACTIVITY 8

Use the professional-services M&A briefing to design a people-and-client integration plan that preserves specialist identity while enabling scaled capabilities.

You'll build

Culture risk map, critical-talent plan, client continuity playbook and stakeholder communication pack

Tools / evidence: Culture diligence · retention · client ownership · change narrative · pulse dashboard

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ACTIVITY 8 · REAL TRANSACTION

Case Scenario — Reported Facts and Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- On 6 August 2026, CPA Practice Advisor reported that The Bonadio Group would add T. Gschwender & Associates (TGA), a Syracuse provider of credit-risk management services to financial institutions. The transaction was expected to close on 16 August 2026; financial terms were not disclosed. TGA was to join Bonadio's internal audit business unit within Advisory & Consulting.
- Source: https://www.financierworldwide.com/briefing-room-ma-in-the-professional-services-sector

Training assumptions / limits

- The briefing emphasises that professional-services value depends heavily on people, client relationships, specialist identity and culture.
- No talent, client or culture problems have been reported for the Bonadio–TGA transaction; the risks below are planning hypotheses.
- Retention should combine financial alignment, career opportunity, clarity and cultural fit.

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ACTIVITY 8 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Activity Questions

1. Which aspects of TGA's specialist identity should be preserved, and which should standardise?
2. Who are the critical talent and client relationships, and what would make them leave?
3. How should leadership explain the transaction to staff and clients?
4. Which leading indicators show culture or client value is deteriorating?

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ACTIVITY 8 · ACCEPTANCE TEST

Bonadio–TGA Culture, Talent and Client Continuity Activity

✅ Test it

The playbook distinguishes preservation from standardisation, names owners and indicators, covers critical talent and clients, and includes a tested response to an early warning.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Stakeholder Alignment and Post-Merger Integration

1

Bonadio–TGA Integration Program Design Activity

Develop an implementation plan with stakeholders and governance (A2, A3, A4)

2

Bonadio–TGA Culture, Talent and Client Continuity Activity

Align stakeholders and manage culture/change in professional-services integration (K2, A2, A3)

3

Decision habit

Separate facts, assumptions and unresolved evidence.

4

Transfer

Carry valuation and diligence commitments into integration ownership.

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WRAP-UP

From Deal Thesis to Realised Value

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COURSE SUMMARY

What You Achieved

1

LO1

Apply financial instruments and valuation methods to structure mergers and acquisitions that optimise organisational benefit and shareholder value.

2

LO2

Evaluate the business, financial and tax impact of potential M&A deals using industry data and forecasting techniques.

3

LO3

Identify, assess and manage M&A risks across the full transaction lifecycle from target selection to post-deal integration.

4

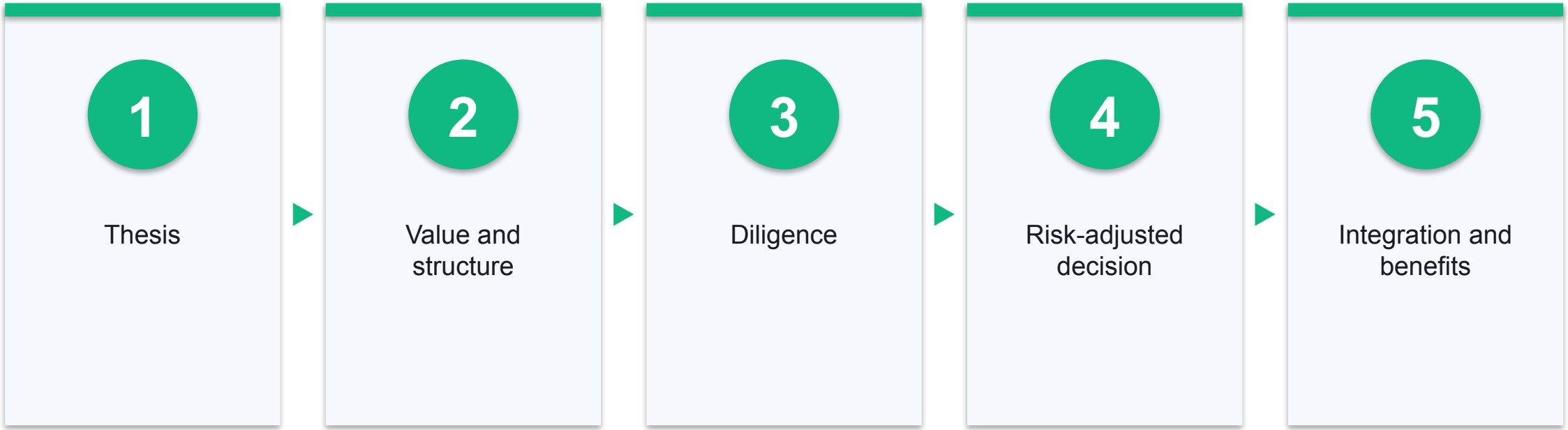
LO4

Collaborate with stakeholders to develop and implement M&A plans while ensuring governance, synergy realisation and strategic alignment.

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TAKEAWAY

The complete M&A discipline



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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources

1

Course page

https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/wsq-strategic-mergers-and-acquisitions-valuation-risk-and-integration.html

2

Bonadio–TGA transaction report

https://www.cpapracticeadvisor.com/2026/08/06/credit-risk-management-firm-joins-the-bonadio-group/188098/

3

M&A risk review

https://www.mdpi.com/2227-9091/12/9/143

4

Professional services M&A briefing

https://www.financierworldwide.com/briefing-room-ma-in-the-professional-services-sector

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1

EY integration program

https://www.ey.com/content/dam/ey-unified-site/ey-com/en-gl/insights/mergers-acquisitions/documents/ey-nine-key-steps-to-setting-up-merger-acquisition-integration-program.pdf

2

Enterprise M&A risk management review

https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=5106493

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LMS

Courseware and Assessment on the LMS

https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

Courseware

Download the current slides and Learner Guide.

Assessment

Open and complete the WA then Case Study.

Submission

Upload completed answers and complete the sign-off process.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment Reminder

WA-SAQ · 4:00–5:00pm

- 4 open-ended questions
- K1–K5
- Open book

Case Study · 5:00–6:00pm

- 3 integrated tasks
- A1–A6
- Open book

Finish

- Submit on LMS
- Digital attendance
- Sign summary record

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM / SSG attendance
2. Assessment digital attendance
3. Sit WA then Case Study
4. Submit answers on the LMS
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

Scan

Use the QR code shown by the trainer.

2

Submit

Complete the assessment attendance event.

3

Confirm

Verify the submission confirmation.

4

Resolve

Tell the trainer immediately if it fails.

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STRATEGIC M&A

Thank You

Make the deal thesis testable, the risk visible and the value accountable.

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